Budgeting Checklist

Business Academy Group Learning · Budgeting · December 2026

Key takeaways

1. **Know your two numbers.** Cost per child and break-even enrollment drive every big decision.
2. **Budget for real life.** Plan for some empty slots and late payments, not a perfect year.
3. **Test before you decide.** Run a scenario before changing tuition, pay, or staffing.
4. **Update it monthly.** A budget only helps if it reflects what is actually happening.
5. **Build a cushion.** Even a small reserve protects your program from surprises.

This month

- ☐ Fixed costs updated in my Budgeting Tool
- ☐ Real enrollment and tuition entered
- ☐ Cost per child calculated
- ☐ Break-even enrollment calculated
- ☐ One scenario tested

Every month

- ☐ Enter last month’s actual income and expenses
- ☐ Compare budget to actual and note big differences
- ☐ Bring questions to coaching

Every year

- ☐ Review tuition rates against cost per child
- ☐ Update insurance, rent, and wage costs
- ☐ Set a reserve goal

My key numbers

Cost per child: _____

Break-even enrollment: _____

Reserve goal: _____

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